Ramanathan Sambandam

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Education

University of California, Berkeley *Graduation Date: May 2028*
B.A. in Business Administration and Data Science *Major GPA: 3.5/4.0*
Relevant Coursework: Financial Accounting, Marketing, Introduction to Economics

Experience

Business/Marketing Analyst June 2025 – Present
Buzju *Remote*
- Led market research on 5+ industry competitors, identifying strategic gaps that informed a product pivot projected to increase user retention by 18%.
- Led competitor analysis to inform upcoming ad campaign strategy and successfully identified over 6 international suppliers to expand sourcing options.
- Monitored campaign performance metrics (website traffic, click-through rates) and generated weekly reports with optimization insights—contributing to a 25% increase in ROI on paid ads.

Strategy Consultant Feb 2025 – May 2025
Paragon Consulting *Berkeley, CA*
- Conducted market and competitor research across 5+ industries, producing insights that supported 3 client strategy projects and improved internal decision turnaround time by 20%.
- Delivered data-driven recommendations using Excel models and PowerPoint, uncovering 3 key growth opportunities that contributed to a 10% projected revenue increase for one client.
- Collaborated with a 4-member consulting team to develop implementation plans and 2 executive summaries, 80% of which were adopted by senior stakeholders.

Undergraduate Apprentice Data Researcher Oct 2024 – Jan 2025
UC Berkeley URAP Program *Berkeley, CA*
- Processed and analyzed 1,000+ data points across economic datasets to identify correlations between regulatory policy and employment growth.
- Used Excel and R for data cleaning, trend analysis, and hypothesis testing in policy-related research projects.

Leadership & Involvement

WaterAI July 2025 – Present
Co-Founder & Marketer *Berkeley, CA*
- Co-founded WaterAI, a hydration tracking app available on the App Store that helps users improve daily water intake through personalized reminders and actionable insights.
- Collaborated on MVP development and testing, securing 50+ downloads during pilot launch.
- Created and executed digital marketing strategies—including social media outreach and app store optimization—resulting in a 35% increase in weekly active users.

Elevare Youth Programs (LittleTalkKids.org + Aspire.Learn) Aug 2024 – Jun 2025
Founder & Director *Berkeley, CA*
- Founded and directed two independent youth organizations: LittleTalkKids.org, a public speaking program, and Aspire. Learn, a college admissions guidance platform.
- Supported 30+ students in developing speaking confidence, academic readiness, and admissions competitiveness for top universities.
- Built and managed program structures, web platforms, and mentorship pipelines—achieving a 100% client satisfaction rate.

Haas Finance Group & Entrepreneurship Program Jan 2025 – May 2025
Committee Member *Berkeley, CA*
- Collaborated with team members to conduct mock deal analyses and DCF valuations.
- Worked with cross-functional teams to pitch startup ideas to real investors and faculty judges.
- Engaged with fellow students and entrepreneurs, gaining exposure to diverse startup ideas and expanding my professional network.

Skills and Interests

Skills: Digital Marketing, E-commerce, Client Relationship Management, Data Analysis (Excel, R, Python)

Interests: Content Creation, Competitive Rugby, Chess, Venture Building